AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Faculty of Business Studies

MKT331
Digital Marketing

Final Examination / Version: B
2025-2026 / SPRING

4 – June – 2026

AOU EGYPT

Number of Exam Pages: 2 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 hours**

Instructions:

1- Take **FIVE (5)** minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
2- Mobile phones must be in "SWITCHED **OFF"** mode throughout the examination.
3- This is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
4- You **MUST** answer the questions using only the answer booklets provided
5- You **MUST** return the examination paper together with your answer booklets.
6- Do **NOT** write your answers in pencil except graphs/sketches
7- Students are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phones during the examination
8- Any form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.
9- This paper has **TWO** sections. You should attempt **ALL** questions in **Section One and Section Two.**

SECTION ONE

Instructions: *You should attempt **ALL** questions in this section.*

Research reveals which emotions make content 'go viral'

The quest for viral content is central to modern marketing, with academic research showing that emotional arousal is key to virality. A 2012 study by Berger and Milkman, analyzing 7,000 *New York Times* articles, found that emotionally charged content—particularly inspiring, awe-inducing, or anger-evoking—was more likely to be widely shared. Notably, high emotional intensity, whether positive or negative, predicted higher email shares than neutral content.

A 2013 YouTube-focused study by Guadagno et al. confirmed similar findings: content that provoked strong emotional responses, regardless of being positive or negative, had a higher chance of being shared.

Additionally, Libert and Tynski (2013) analyzed viral images on Reddit using Plutchik's Wheel of Emotion. They discovered that surprise and anticipation were the most common emotional triggers in highly shared content.

Across platforms, emotional intensity—especially surprise, awe, anger, or inspiration—is a strong predictor of viral potential.

Question One: (40 marks)

a) **Drawing on the case study, explain how emotional triggers shape consumers' willingness to share content. Which emotions are most effective for virality, and why? Include examples (20 marks).**

b) **Using the research findings, propose four evidence-based strategies marketers can apply to increase the likelihood that campaign content will be shared widely ("go viral") (20 marks)?**

AOU EGYPT

SECTION TWO

Instructions: *You should attempt **ALL** questions in this section.*

Question Two: (30 marks)

If you need to update a product page on your company website, what six steps would you take to do it properly? Briefly explain each step.

Question Three: (30 marks)

You are advising a business moving from traditional to digital marketing. What are ten major differences in strategy, execution, and measurement they should be aware of? Provide brief practical examples where relevant.